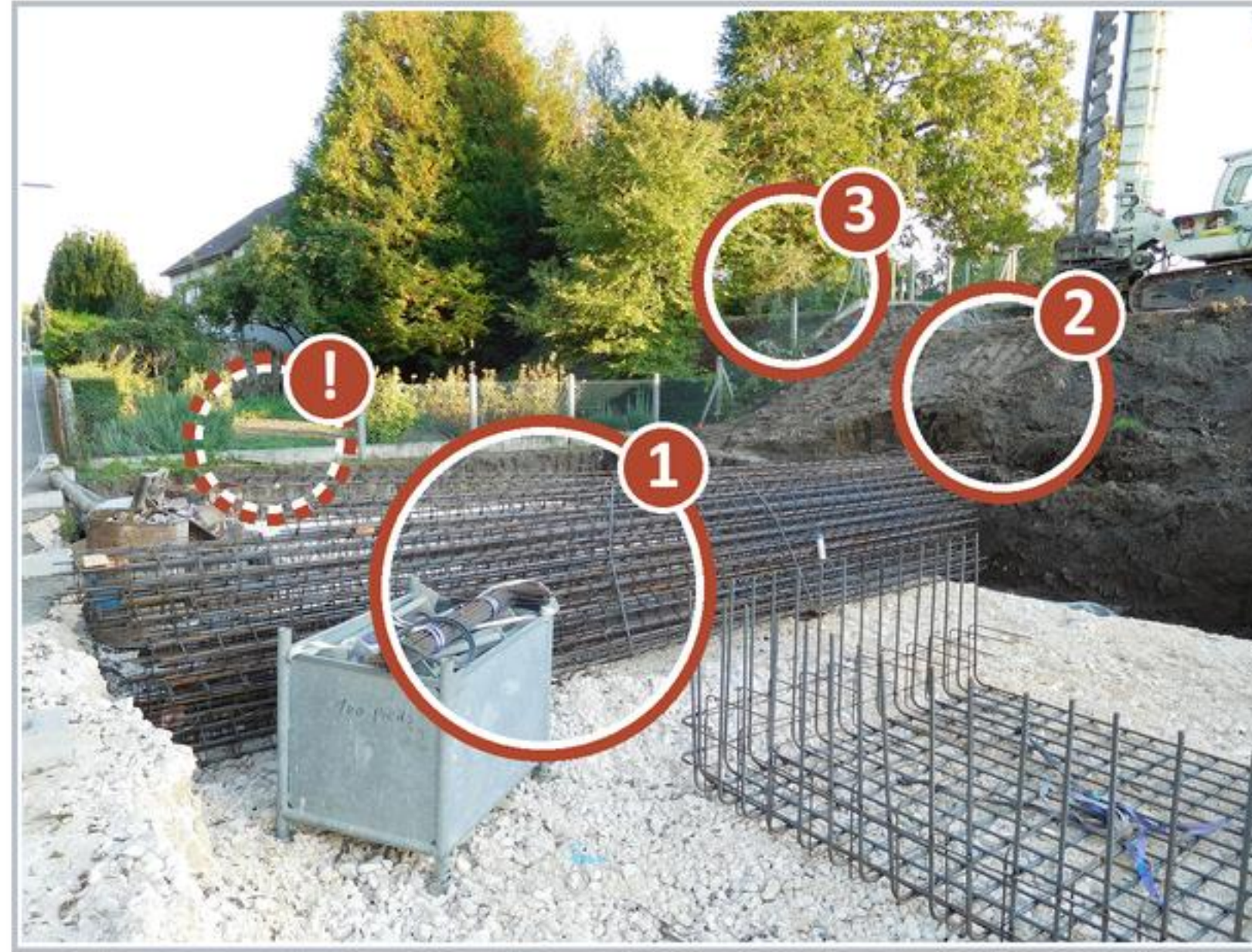


WORKED EXAMPLE

Jack Mo reads it aloud

Foundations & rebar

THE UNTRAINED EYE vs THE RISK MANAGER'S EYE



Jack Mo circles what his eye lands on — and the one thing that should be there and isn't.

To a passing eye this is just the start of a building — a clean rectangular hole in the ground, neat steel cages standing in rows, plywood forms waiting for concrete. Honest, simple, almost done with the hard part. A risk manager looks at the same hole and feels the floor drop, because they are not reading the steel. They are reading the soil the steel disappears into — the one part of the whole job nobody can fully see. The ordinary eye sees an excavation that is finished. The trained eye sees a question that is still open: what is down there that the geotechnical report was too thin to promise? Was that report based on three borings or thirty? The casual eye trusts the existing drawings; the trained eye assumes the as-builts are wrong until the field proves them right. The casual eye sees a dry pit; the trained eye watches the corner for the first dark seep of a high water table. The casual eye counts a beautiful rebar cage; the trained eye counts the same cage and asks whether crews rushed the dense bars into the wrong spacing. Everything below grade is a rumor until it is verified. The scene did not change between those two readings — the hole, the steel, the forms are identical. The eye did.

THIS SCENE FEEDS YOUR REGISTER

R25 • R29 • R33 • R37 • R41 — the five students dealt this scene.

The discipline under that read

The moves you run so you can see it too — then five register rows fall out of one glance.

LOOK	sweep overhead → working level → ground/openings → edges → background (don't lock on the obvious).
SPLIT	say what you SEE — facts only: A rectangular excavation cut into the ground, with exposed soil faces and the open bottom of the building., Rows of vertical steel rebar cages standing in the foundation footprint, tied and waiting., Foundation formwork — plywood and bracing — set to receive concrete..
NOTICE	circle the cues: The exposed soil faces of the cut — color, layering, any change from sand to rock to soft clay; The low corner of the excavation where water would first collect; The bar spacing and tie pattern on the densest rebar cage — and the missing There is no sign anyone proved what is underground before digging — no utility locate paint or flags, no dewatering pumps staged for groundwater, and no visible confirmation that the existing-condition drawings were checked against the actual field. The missing thing is verification of the invisible.
ASK → PROJECT	what releases it, who's in the path, what happens next — and in which phase.

NAME · five rows, born from one glance (cause → event → consequence)

1 Subsurface

Because the geotechnical investigation was thin and the real ground is unknown, crews may hit rock, water, or soft soil while digging, leading to foundation redesign and rework that delays everything built above it.

Owner: Superintendent · Trigger: Field conditions in the excavation do not match the assumptions in the geotechnical report.

2 Utilities

Because the ground hides utilities that may be unmapped, an excavator may strike or sever a live line, leading to an emergency relocation, a safety incident, and a halt to digging.

3 As-builts

Because the existing-condition drawings may be inaccurate, the field will not match the plans, leading to redesign of the foundation layout and lost time reconciling what was drawn against what is real.

4 Groundwater

Because a high water table can rise into an open pit, the excavation may flood, leading to stopped work, unstable soil, and dewatering costs before any concrete can be placed.

5 Rebar quality

Because dense rebar is hard to place and easy to rush, the steel may be set with wrong spacing or cover, leading to rejected inspections and cages that must be torn out and reset.

READING MOVE · bank this card

“At the foundations, treat everything you cannot see as a risk until it is proven — read the soil, not the steel, and assume the ground, the utilities, and the as-builts are lying to you until the field confirms otherwise.”

SUCCESS CARD · check the read against these six

- ☐ a real, visible cue
- ☐ cause is a site condition
- ☐ a future event
- ☐ consequence on cost/time/quality/safety
- ☐ owner + early-warning trigger
- ☐ (M4) P and I each defended

P × I? Not yet — Module 2 IDENTIFIES; Module 4 ASSESSES. These rows seed register rows R25 · R29 · R33 · R37 · R41.